Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-15

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 26:1-19

1 Concerning the divisions of the gatekeepers: of the Korahites, Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph.

2 And the sons of Meshelemiah were Zechariah the firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth,

3 Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, Eliehoenai the seventh.

4 Moreover the sons of Obed-Edom were Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, Sacar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth,

5 Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peulthai the eighth; for God blessed him.

6 Also to Shemaiah his son were sons born who governed their fathers' houses, because they were men of great ability.

7 The sons of Shemaiah were Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad, whose brothers Elihu and Semachiah were able men.

8 All these were of the sons of Obed-Edom, they and their sons and their brethren, able men with strength for the work: sixty-two of Obed-Edom.

9 And Meshelemiah had sons and brethren, eighteen able men.

10 Also Hosah, of the children of Merari, had sons: Shimri the first (for though he was not the firstborn, his father made him the first),

11 Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, Zechariah the fourth; all the sons and brethren of Hosah were thirteen.

12 Among these were the divisions of the gatekeepers, among the chief men, having duties just like their brethren, to serve in the house of the Lord.

13 And they cast lots for each gate, the small as well as the great, according to their father's house.

14 The lot for the East Gate fell to Shelemiah. Then they cast lots for his son Zechariah, a wise counselor, and his lot came out for the North Gate;

15 to Obed-Edom the South Gate, and to his sons the storehouse.

16 To Shuppim and Hosah the lot came out for the West Gate, with the Shallecheth Gate on the ascending highway—watchman opposite watchman.

17 On the east were six Levites, on the north four each day, on the south four each day, and for the storehouse two by two.

18 As for the Parbar on the west, there were four on the highway and two at the Parbar.

19 These were the divisions of the gatekeepers among the sons of Korah and among the sons of Merari.

II. Key Summary

• The passage lists three families of gatekeepers: Meshelemiah of the Korahites (18 sons and brothers), Obed-Edom (62 descendants—the text adds "for God blessed him"), and Hosah of the Merarites (13 in all), and calls them "able men with strength for the work."

• These chief gatekeepers served in the house of the Lord just like their brothers, and they cast lots for each gate, "the small as well as the great," family by family.

• The lots gave the East Gate to Shelemiah, the North Gate to Zechariah, the South Gate to Obed-Edom, the storehouse to his sons, and the West Gate to Shuppim and Hosah; each day there were six Levites on the east, four on the north, four on the south, two by two at the storehouse, four on the western highway, and two at the Parbar.

III. Passage Analysis

Guarding a Gate Is Serving God

> "As God's people pay proper attention to their status as a worshipping community, the distinction between the sacred and the secular disappears. All tasks, whether mundane or specialized, 'religious' or 'lay', have value in the eyes of God." [1]

Standing at a gate doesn't sound as important as offering sacrifices or leading worship, but the passage says these men served "just like their brethren." Up front or behind the

scenes, it all counts with God.

Whatever Gate the Lot Gives You

> "The gatekeeping posts were assigned to each 'father's house' regardless of age, ability, or experience—'small as well as great, they cast lots by their father's house for each gate.'" [2]

Who got the East Gate and who got the storehouse wasn't decided by who was older or more impressive—it was left to God. In God's house, your place isn't something you win by status; it's something God gives you.

IV. Reflection Question

The gatekeepers guarded whatever gate the lot gave them. Think of the last time you were assigned a job nobody notices—sweeping, stacking chairs, standing at the door. What did you actually do?

The passage says the gatekeepers served "in the house of the Lord" just like their brothers: guarding one gate was serving God as much as the work up front, and what God looks at is whether you kept the gate He gave you.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 26 – The Gatekeepers for the Temple" (quoting Selman), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-26/

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), "1 Chronicles 26 Notes" (Comprehensive Commentary on 1 Chronicles), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT26.htm